jailed militants including Maulana Masood Azhar, questions were raised over the lack of forewarning. Two months later, it was learned that a R&AW operative in Kathmandu had informed his senior about the terror plot, but the memorandum was never sent to New Delhi.

'We learned that the R&AW officer was harassed when he filed the report warning the government about the terrorists' plan to hijack the aircraft. His immediate senior was very unhappy and kept the report in his drawer. It was never sent to headquarters for further action. So we were not sleeping. But there are times when you cannot do anything despite having an accurate input on future events. The IC 814 hijacking was one such example/ Di-wakar said.

Nevertheless, due to the IC 814 hijack, the Indian government started looking at loopholes in the security apparatus of Nepal and found too many loose ends. After the intelligence fiasco that led to the Kargil war and the subsequent report submitted by the Kargil Review Committee, the then prime minister, Atal Bihari Vajpayee, set up a Group of Ministers (GoM) on 17 April 2000 to review the national security system. The GoM, headed by then Home Minister Lal Krishna Advani, with Defence Minister George Fernandes, External Affairs Minister Jaswant Singh and Finance Minister Yashwant Sinha, was mandated to formulate specific proposals for implementation. The GoM came to the conclusion that the ISI had been able to built new networks in Nepal. They also said that the dynamic nature of problems related to the management of borders was highlighted by the manner in which the India-Nepal border had changed over a period of time. The open boundary had once been peaceful and trouble-free, but with the increasing activities of the ISI in Nepal, the nature of the border had